



A Just Future The G20 Development Working Group's agenda is expected to bring the world back on the path to meeting the Sustainable Development Goals



“Countries must use SDGs as a prescriptive framework to push for an interconnected approach that leaves no one behind, and not reduce it to a monitoring or tracking metric”

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\$2.5 trillion pre-pandemic. Even as the SDG financing gap has increased, the availability of resources has decreased,” adds Kathel of UNDP India.

Addressing this gap would require a complex blend of public and private resources. There is increased awareness that addressing SDG-related financing gaps will require significant improvements in mobilising domestic resources, accessing innovative private finance, and leveraging co-operation on international development.

To aid this process, India has called for a greater collaboration of international financial institutions (IFIs) including multilateral development banks (MDBs), as well as to catalyse investments to support the implementation of the SDGs, says Ajay Kumar Pillai, Partner of Risk Advisory at Deloitte India.

In this backdrop, and with the seven-year agenda, the SDG Summit scheduled for September 18-19 in New York promises to mark the beginning of a new phase of accelerated progress towards the SDGs. Countries must now recommit to fulfilling the Addis Ababa Action Agenda—which aimed to align financing flows and policies with the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development—and mobilise resources and investments to help developing countries, especially those that are most vulnerable, achieve the SDGs. “To achieve this, coun-

tries must endorse and implement the \$500-billion per year SDG stimulus plan by 2030. This requires immediate action towards addressing the high cost of debt, [and] scaling up affordable and long-term financing,” adds Sandhu of Primus Partners.

There are other challenges, too, that may impact progress towards meeting these SDGs. Significant differences emerged at the G20 Environment and Climate Ministers’ Meeting on the question of energy transition, a fact that was highlighted at the subsequent Energy Transitions Ministers’ Meeting as well.

And all this while that clock set in motion in 2015 has continued to tick.

As the race to achieve the SDGs intensifies, some goals will be met significantly, while others will take time. For instance, while poverty levels have declined sharply in India in recent times and access to clean water has improved, there’s still work to be done in terms of ensuring gender equality. Building on the lessons from the response to Covid-19, a concerted effort needs to be made where digital platforms combine with civil society and an agile administration to bring about the transformation. **BT**

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